TASK 1 — STOCK ANALYSIS REPORT

Apple (AAPL) • Microsoft (MSFT) • NVIDIA (NVDA)

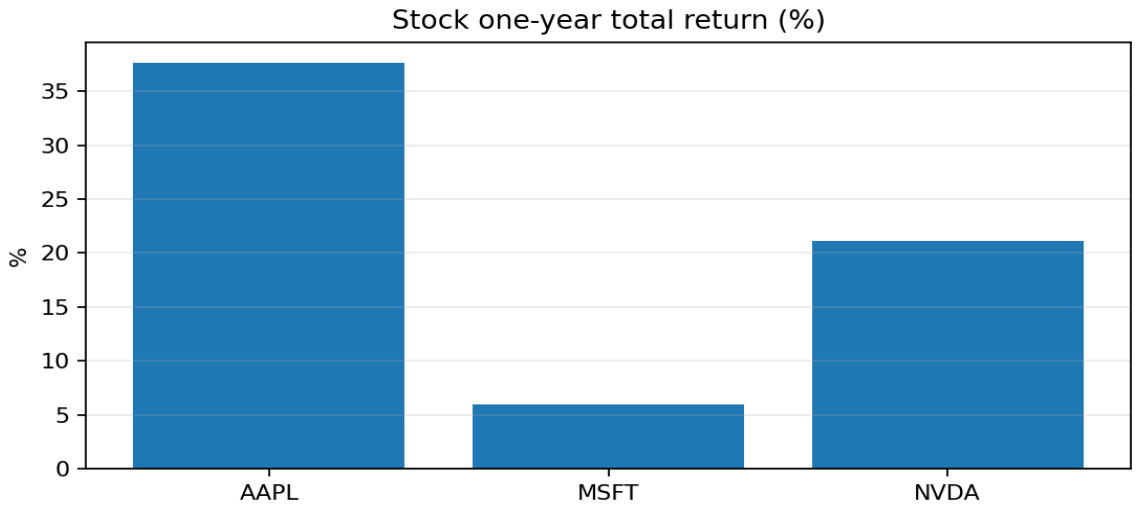
Prepared: 18 October 2026 | Student name: ~~Fardowsa Abdisalam Ali~~

Educational assignment only; not investment advice. Verify figures and source dates before submission.

1. Objective and method

This report compares three U.S.-listed technology companies using business models, trailing one-year total return, valuation indicators and key risks. Return figures are Yahoo Finance snapshots as of 15 October 2026. Closing prices are around 15 October; market capitalization and P/E snapshots have slightly different update dates, so they are approximate.

Ticker / company	Close (USD)	1-year return	Market cap approx.	Trailing P/E
AAPL / Apple Inc.	$342.00	+37.67%	~$4.99T	39.18x
MSFT / Microsoft Corporation	$539.44	+5.93%	~$4.02T	27.74x
NVDA / NVIDIA Corporation	$217.23	+21.09%	~$5.24T	27.46x



2. Company analysis

Apple Inc. (AAPL)

Apple sells consumer devices and services in an integrated hardware/software ecosystem. Strengths include brand loyalty, its services ecosystem and cash generation. Key risks include a premium valuation, product-cycle dependence, competition, regulation and supply-chain exposure.

Microsoft Corporation (MSFT)

Microsoft operates in cloud services, enterprise software, productivity tools, gaming and AI-enabled products. Strengths include recurring enterprise revenue, Azure/cloud expansion and a diversified software portfolio. Risks include cloud-growth expectations, AI infrastructure spending, competition and valuation sensitivity.

NVIDIA Corporation (NVDA)

NVIDIA designs GPUs and accelerated-computing platforms used in AI, data centres and gaming. Its strengths include its AI accelerator position, software ecosystem and data-centre demand. Risks include semiconductor cycles, export restrictions, competition, customer concentration and high market expectations.

3. Interpretation

Apple had the strongest one-year return in this comparison (+37.67%), followed by NVIDIA (+21.09%) and Microsoft (+5.93%). Past performance does not predict future returns. Apple's higher trailing P/E suggests investors pay more relative to recent earnings; that may reflect growth expectations but leaves less room for disappointment. NVIDIA is exposed to AI infrastructure demand, while Microsoft's diversified enterprise model is balanced against cloud and AI-spending expectations.

4. Conclusion

These companies have different risk-return profiles despite all being technology-related. A sound analysis should also review earnings quality, cash flow, debt, competitive position and valuation, and avoid excessive sector concentration. This report is a point-in-time educational comparison, not a buy/sell recommendation.

References

• Yahoo Finance AAPL (performance/valuation, accessed 15 Oct 2026) — https://finance.yahoo.com/quote/AAPL/

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